The Gujarat Government has also developed a "GO for Gold, Gujarat" strategy to train and motivate its sportspersons to achieve higher levels of excellence and emerge as winners in the 36th National Games.



An event around this strategy was organised on 13th September, 2022, when the present government completed a year in office. During this event, the Hon'ble CM interacted with the sportspersons and announced 'excellence incentives' to recognise their performance in the upcoming Games. At the event, Indian National Badminton Team Coach Pullela Gopichand and Indian Shooter Anjali Bhagwat interacted with the players who are participating from Gujarat in the National Games and inspired them. While Shri Gopichand advised focusing on diet, nutrition and a positive attitude, Arjuna Award and Khel Ratna Award winner Smt. Bhagwat reminded the athletes that her career started from Ahmedabad.

Taking the community movement forward, a sports carnival was organised from 15th September to 18th September, 2022 in the six host cities. Fun activities were planned in this carnival including sports, immersive experiences, and cultural programmes.

SWARNIM GUJARAT SPORTS UNIVERSITY

During the grand inaugural event of the 36th National Games, the Prime Minister also inaugurated the world-class Swarnim Gujarat Sports University (SGSU) in Desar virtually. SGSU was established in 2011 by Shri Modi when he was the Hon'ble Chief Minister of Gujarat with the vision of making Gujarat a sporting powerhouse of India. Currently being operated from Gandhinagar, SGSU will have a state-of-the-art campus at Desar. The University provides learning in five major disciplines and is well equipped with world-class facilities including labs and R&D facilities. SGSU offers unique courses in Physical Education Sport Sciences; Fitness & Wellness; Sports Management; Sports Tourism; and Advance Training and Coaching. Besides, SGSU is affiliated with 10+ institutions and has signed MOWs with over 30 national and international universities with focus on knowledge exchange. More than 3,000 students from across the country have enrolled here in the last three years and the University has played a pivotal role in making sports education accessible to all.

The new and bigger campus was envisaged by Hon'ble Prime Minister Narendra Modi at Desar, Vadodara. Desar is around 105 kms (2 hours) from Ahmedabad and 53 kms (1.5 hours) from Vadodara city. The new campus is spread over 130 acres and includes an indoor multipurpose hall (including basketball, badminton, volleyball, table tennis facilities); outdoor sports facilities (including Olympic-sized swimming pool, 400m athletics track, etc); practice grounds for handball, volleyball, kho kho; kabaddi, and so on; and residential buildings for students, administrative block and staff quarters. All this has been done at an investment of around Rs 108 crores till date. The operations of the existing campus in Gandhinagar will be shifted to the new SGSU campus in Desar soon.

GUJARAT'S FORWARD-LOOKING SPORTS POLICY 2022-27

Earlier this year, the Government of Gujarat unveiled a new Sports Policy 2022-27. The objective of the Sports Policy is to change the sports scenario in Gujarat. An equal emphasis has been laid on promoting the sports talent in Gujarat and also creating world-class sports infrastructure across the state. Through this policy, the Gujarat Government aims to encourage and promote sports culture by organising national and international tournaments and giving prizes to all sportspersons. The Government also wants to conduct amateur and professional sports leagues and implement efficient sports governance in Gujarat.

- The Policy's far-reaching vision is to leverage sports as a vehicle to achieve multi-pronged benefits to society including improved health and well-being of citizens, excellence of sportspersons from the state at the global stage, as well as growth of sports manufacturing and sports tourism in Gujarat.

